PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Nissan Patrol Y61 (GU)

1997–2016 (later in some markets) · Y61 · GU · GR

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Identify the engine and series first**
  Make sure the engine and gearbox match the build date and series. A 'Series III ZD30' and a 'Series IV TB48' are different buys. A ZD30 sold as 'overhauled' should come with an itemised list: head, bores, pistons, bearings and rings, not just new pistons and a turbo.

- [ ] **ZD30: demand oil history and check the dipstick**
  Look for regular oil changes and the right grade: a September 2004 Nissan bulletin, quoted by owners, calls for ACEA B3 or JASO DH-1 oil with 10W-40 strongly recommended. Nissan Europe's Y61 service manual schedules ZD30 oil and filter every 15,000 km or 12 months, or every 7,500 km or 6 months in severe use such as towing, dust or short trips. Check your own market's service book; many owners change it more often. Fuel in the oil is bad news. One forum veteran says heavy soot within 5,000 km points to an open EGR, and another warns that factory intercoolers eventually leak, so check for oil staining. Listen for knocks on a cold start.

- [ ] **Cooling under load**
  Every GU engine can overheat when towing, and the TD42 has a particular reputation for it. Check the radiator core, the foam seals between condenser and radiator, and the fan clutch (it should drag and turn only about half a revolution when cold). Watch the temperature gauge on a long climb.

- [ ] **Manual gearbox**
  Drive through every gear. Owners report fifth-gear spline and hub problems and worn 2nd-to-3rd synchros on the five-speed.

- [ ] **Rear axle seals, diffs and underbody**
  Put it on a hoist. Look for wet rear backing plates from leaking axle seals, bash plates pushed up into what they're meant to protect, and damage to sills and bumpers. Find out whether the rear diff is an H233B or an H260 if you plan to fit a locker.

- [ ] **Cab-chassis: look behind the cab**
  ExplorOz members report cracks in GU cab-chassis frames just behind the cab and near the rear axle on heavily loaded trays, repaired by plating. Check under any big service body.

- [ ] **Rear barn door and dash**
  Owners report cracks in the big rear door that carries the spare, down the side of the window on the left-hand side. Dashboard tops can blister; Nissan Japan extended the warranty to seven years on specified wagons built August 2004 to June 2007.

- [ ] **Previous lift work**
  A lifted GU that wanders or steers vaguely probably needs caster correction. Lifts of about 3 in or more also need longer panhard rods, drag-link changes and longer brake lines. Ask what was fitted and whether it was certified.

YEARS TO KNOW

1999	SWEET SPOT	TD42T turbo-diesel added (to the ST in Australia). It's mechanically injected with no electronic engine control. CarsGuide calls the TD42 turbo-diesel 'the pick of the Patrol engines from this era'
2000	BEWARE	GU II (April): 3.0 L four-cylinder ZD30DDTi diesel arrives with an optional automatic. The naturally aspirated TD42 reportedly left the wagon range around this time. Early ZD30s (2000–2003 in Westside Auto's guide) are known for piston and bottom-end failures
2003	SWEET SPOT	Factory-intercooled TD42Ti arrives, with electronic injection timing from February. ST-L grade added. 4X4 Australia rates its reliability and simplicity for remote travel, and Westside Auto names the 2005–07 TD42T ST and ST-L as the GU's sweet spot

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Names and codes**
  Y61 is Nissan's series code. Australia calls it the GU, Japan sold it as the Safari, and Europe called it the Patrol GR. Known codes include WRGY61 (1997 Japanese TD42T wagon) and UY61 (Australian cab-chassis).
- ☐ **Which series**
  GU I runs from 1997 and GU II from April 2000. GU III (October 2001) brought a new nose. GU IV (October 2004) is the easy one to spot, with new headlights, boxy wheel-arch flares and larger tail lights. Later series are GU VI (September 2007) and GU VII (2010).
- ☐ **Which engine**
  Petrol trucks have the 4.5 L TB45 (1997–2001) or 4.8 L TB48DE (late 2001 on). Diesels are the 2.8 L RD28ETi, the 4.2 L TD42 family (naturally aspirated, then TD42T from 1999, then intercooled TD42Ti from 2003) or the 3.0 L four-cylinder ZD30. Every ZD30 carries the ZD30DDTi name, but before 2007 it used a VP44 distributor pump and from 2007 it's common-rail, so check which one you're looking at.
- ☐ **Coil or leaf rear**
  Wagons have coil springs at both ends. Cab-chassis utes were also sold with a leaf-spring rear axle, such as the 2011 'DX (Leaf Spring) Wide Wheel' in Australia.

- [ ] **Build date for US import**
  US eligibility runs 25 years from the vehicle's own manufacture date, not its model year. Read the build plate before money changes hands. A late-2001 GU III with a TB48 may not be legal to import yet even though the model launched that year.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/nissan-patrol/y61/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks